



Illustrative: Ship in the Agua Clara locks of the expanded Panama Canal · Photo: Mariordo (Mario Roberto Durán Ortiz) · CC BY-SA 4....

30 September Wednesday · 2026 · Issue #2

DAILY TRADE FLOW SCAN

Panama eases limits, Yanbu reloads, US dairy exports at record pace

51

trade-flow signals

7

critical

2/9

lanes with signals

YESTERDAY AT A GLANCE

51 signals, 7 critical. The three that matter most, then the rest of the radar.

- **Panama Canal lifts Neopanamax transits to 10 a day from Oct. 15**

freightwaves.com · slides 3–4

- **Yanbu crude loadings resume after East-West Pipeline restart**

marinelink.com · slides 5–6

- **US cheese and butterfat exports at record levels, CoBank says**

brownfieldagnews.com · slides 7–8

ALSO ON THE RADAR

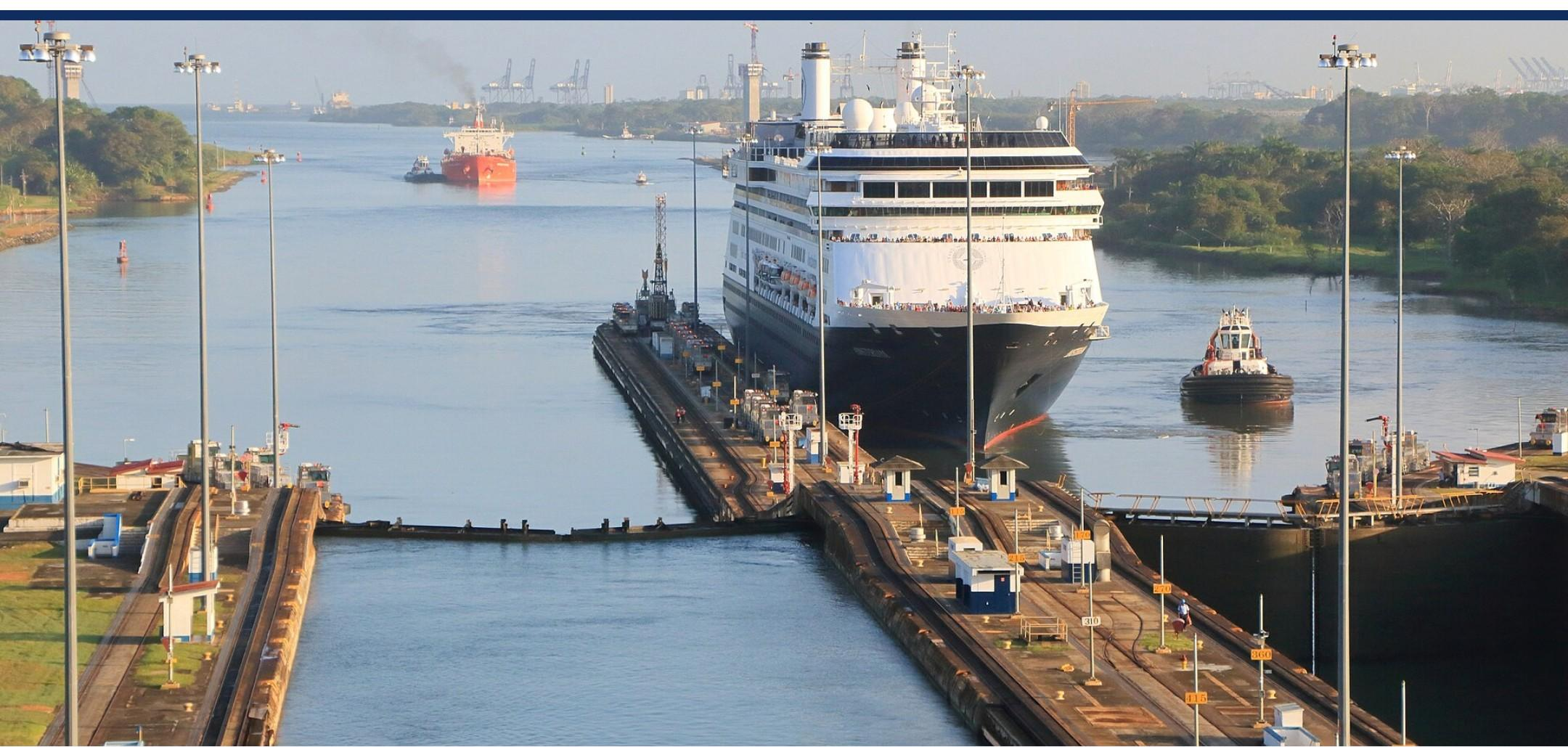
- Canadian oil sands production to hit record 3.5 MMbpd in 2026, S&P Global says
worldoil.com

- Puntland Forces Rescue Vessel Hijacked by Somali Pirates
marinelink.com

- Soybeans rebound as corn drifts downward
brownfieldagnews.com

- Finalists Announced for 2026 Transition Trucking: Driving for Excellence Award
freightwaves.com

- Fog of War Deepens in Hormuz as Ship Attacks Go Unreported for Days
gcaptain.com · Strait of Hormuz



Illustrative: Ship moving westbound through a Panama Canal lock chamber · Photo: Paul Harrison · CC BY-SA 4.0 · Wikimedia Com...

SIGNAL 1 OF 3

Critical

Shipping

Panama Canal lifts Neopanamax transits to 10 a day from Oct. 15

49 ft

Neopanamax max draft, restored with immediate effect

The Panama Canal Authority will raise daily Neopanamax-lock transits to 10 from Oct. 15. That lifts total capacity across the Neopanamax and Panamax locks to 33 slots, FreightWaves reports.

SIGNAL 1 OF 3 • WHY IT MATTERS

Panama Canal lifts Neopanamax transits to 10 a day from Oct. 15

WHY IT MATTERS

A deeper draft lets ships carry more cargo through the canal. One industry estimate says a 10,000-TEU ship loses about 450 TEUs per foot of draft restriction. Delayed passages hit US East and Gulf Coast port berths, rail and chassis.

KEY FACTS

- The increase is based on present and projected Gatun Lake levels after near-average rainfall.
 - Earlier drought cuts reduced total daily capacity to as few as 32 ships in mid-September.
 - Ports named: New York-New Jersey, Norfolk, Savannah, Charleston, Miami, Houston, New Orleans.
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WHAT TO WATCH

The Oct. 15 slot increase. The authority says the watershed is still in deficit and only a reservation guarantees a crossing date.

SOURCE freightwaves.com • 2026-09-30



Illustrative: Aerial view of the Brod oil refinery with storage tanks and river · Photo: Petar Milošević · CC BY-SA 4.0 · Wikimedia Com...

SIGNAL 2 OF 3

Critical

Shipping

Yanbu crude loadings resume after East-West Pipeline restart

2.65m bpd

Pipeline throughput per Kpler, vs 7m bpd capacity

Saudi Arabia has resumed tanker loadings at its Red Sea port of Yanbu, MarineLink and Reuters report. The East-West Pipeline was shut on September 11 after drone attacks that the kingdom blamed on Iraqi militias.

SIGNAL 2 OF 3 · WHY IT MATTERS

Yanbu crude loadings resume after East-West Pipeline restart

WHY IT MATTERS

The restart adds to signs of more oil flowing from the Middle East, where the US war with Iran has throttled shipments. Kpler sees 3-4m bpd in the coming days and says a return to the pre-attack ~5.5m bpd could take another month.

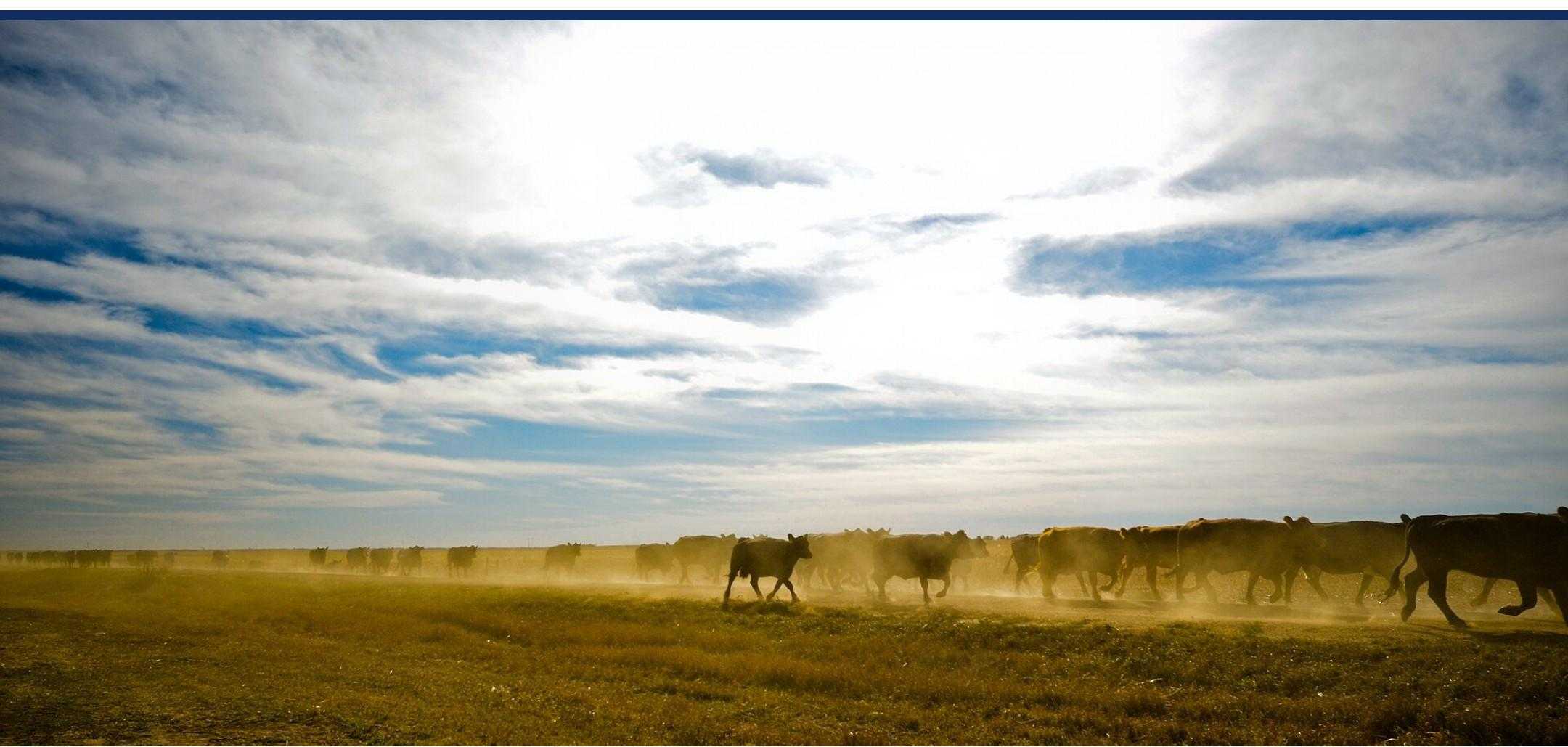
KEY FACTS

- TankerTrackers: ESA imagery from Sept 27 shows nearly 10m barrels of crude loading at Yanbu and Al Muajjiz.
 - Two trade sources estimate Yanbu crude loadings at about 2m bpd since last week.
 - Pipeline operations resumed last Tuesday, and a refiner loaded a cargo from Yanbu late last week.
-

WHAT TO WATCH

Aramco's October Yanbu loading schedule, sent to customers on Monday, and whether throughput reaches Kpler's 3-4m bpd in the coming days.

SOURCE marinelink.com + 1 more report · 2026-09-30



Illustrative: cattle drive raising dust across grassland in South Dakota · Photo: Carl Young · CC BY-SA 4.0 · Wikimedia Commons

SIGNAL 3 OF 3

Critical

Agriculture

US cheese and butterfat exports at record levels, CoBank says

15 to 17

Percent of US milk output exported, past two years

CoBank ag economist Abbi Groves told Brownfield that US butterfat and cheese exports have hit records and that 2026 could be another record year for US dairy exports.

SIGNAL 3 OF 3 · WHY IT MATTERS

US cheese and butterfat exports at record levels, CoBank says

WHY IT MATTERS

Groves says exports are important because cheese and butterfat are in surplus in the domestic market. The report names no routes, volumes or freight costs.

KEY FACTS

- Groves expects the 2026 export share of US milk production to be closer to 17 percent.
 - Groves says the current export pace resembles the end of 2025.
 - She spoke to Brownfield at the World Pork Expo in Madison, Wisconsin, on Tuesday.
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WHAT TO WATCH

Full-year 2026 export results for cheese and butterfat, where Groves expects records in both categories.

SOURCE brownfieldagnews.com · 2026-09-30

LANE RISK BOARD • LAST 7 DAYS



Strait of Hormuz leads with 3 signals and 7-day pressure of 43, down from 48. Red Sea & Suez rose to 9 from 6, and Gulf of Aden fell to 1 from 15.

Last 7 days 7 days before

Strait of Hormuz +3		High
Red Sea & Suez Canal +1		Watch
Black Sea & Turkish Straits		Watch
Panama Canal		Watch
Mediterranean, Gibraltar & N. Europe		Watch
Gulf of Aden / Bab el-Mandeb		Watch
Strait of Malacca		Quiet
South China Sea / Taiwan Strait		Quiet
Cape of Good Hope route		Quiet

Pressure = critical×3 + elevated×2 + watch×1 over 7 days · +N = signals on 30 Sept 2026

EVERY SIGNAL, EVERY DAY

**All 51 of yesterday's signals are pinned
on the live trade-flow map**

[worldtrade.pro.com](https://worldtrade.pro)

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history at [worldtrade.pro.com/trade-lanes](https://worldtrade.pro/trade-lanes)

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